

Monday, 6 July 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

33° 19°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

29° 17°

MANCHESTER

Overcast

20° 16°

GLASGOW

Drizzle

18° 14°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1

Get ready for another heatwave this week, with temperatures expected to hit a scorching 34 degrees Celsius!

A week-long health alert has been issued as the UK braces for significantly longer periods of high temperatures. Make sure you're staying hydrated and keeping cool.

WEATHER · UK

2

The Health Secretary is seeking advice after some staff refused to give evidence to a maternity inquiry.

James Murray said he felt 'numb' hearing from families affected by the scandal. This comes as concerns continue about patient safety in maternity services.

HEALTH · UK

3

Police leadership in England and Wales needs a 'fundamental overhaul', according to a major new report.

Former home secretary Lord Blunkett, a co-author, says forces need an 'ethical reset'. It highlights serious concerns about the running of our police services.

LAW & ORDER · UK

4

Reform UK leader Nigel Farage is facing questions over undeclared benefits from an ally.

The Sunday Times reports he failed to register support from a cryptocurrency entrepreneur with a fraud conviction. Reform UK denies any rules were broken.

POLITICS · UK

5

Police are investigating claims that £1.5 million raised for the Yes Scotland campaign is 'unaccounted for'.

The funds were intended for the group that campaigned for Scottish independence in the 2014 referendum. The allegations are now subject to a police probe.

POLITICS · UK

What's coming up

- 1 **It's official! Taylor Swift and Travis Kelce have tied the knot in a star-studded ceremony in New York City!**
The couple exchanged vows on Friday, with Adam Sandler reportedly officiating. Several streets in Midtown Manhattan were shut down as fans gathered to celebrate.
ON AIR – What's your favourite celebrity wedding story? Or what song do you think Taylor and Travis had their first dance to?
CELEBRITY · NOW

- 2 **Big news in the TV world: Sky is expected to announce its purchase of ITV's TV and streaming channels very soon!**
This could mean big changes for your favourite shows and how you watch them. It's a huge shake-up for British television.
ON AIR – If Sky buys ITV, what changes would you like to see? Or what's your go-to ITV show?
TV · SOON

- 3 **A new album from The Specials, taken from their 2019 performances, is set to be released this month.**
It's being hailed as a fitting tribute to the band's much-loved frontman, Terry Hall. Fans are eagerly anticipating this final collection of live recordings.
ON AIR – Are you a fan of The Specials? What's your favourite track, and what memories does their music bring back?
MUSIC · THIS MONTH

- 4 **Harlesden in north-west London is launching a Reggae Walk of Fame, celebrating its rich musical heritage!**
The trail will honour the area's reggae legends and Windrush pioneers. It's a fantastic way to recognise their cultural impact.
ON AIR – What's your favourite reggae artist or song? Or what other types of music deserve their own 'walk of fame'?
CULTURE · NOW

- 5 **Star Wars fans, listen up! A seaside town near Blackpool is where Stormtroopers patrol the beach every year!**
It's a regular gathering for fans of the Star Wars prequel 'Andor', which used the location for filming. A truly unique sight for holidaymakers!
ON AIR – If you could visit any famous film location, where would it be? Or what's your favourite Star Wars movie?
FILM · ANNUAL

On the schedule

1 **England faces a massive challenge against Mexico in the World Cup last 16, battling history and a passionate home crowd in the Azteca cauldron!**

Chief football writer Phil McNulty says England will be up against an entire nation. The team will need to be at their absolute best to progress.

ON AIR – Do you think England can overcome the legendary Azteca atmosphere and make it to the quarter-finals?
FOOTBALL · UK

2 **British wildcard Arthur Fery has battled through a five-set thriller to reach the fourth round of Wimbledon!**

He came back from two sets down against Zizou Bergs in a match lasting nearly five hours. It's the first time he's made it this far in a Grand Slam.

ON AIR – What a performance from Arthur Fery! What's the most exciting tennis match you've ever watched?
TENNIS · UK

3 **A rivalry renewed at Wimbledon as Aryna Sabalenka and Naomi Osaka meet for a place in the quarter-finals!**

This will be their third clash in just three months, promising another thrilling encounter on the grass courts. It's a must-watch match for tennis fans.

ON AIR – Who are you backing in the Sabalenka vs Osaka match? And who do you think will win Wimbledon this year?
TENNIS · UK

4 **Jacob Bethell starred for England, guiding them to an impressive four-wicket win against India in the second T20!**

Bethell hit an unbeaten 76 as England recovered from 1-2 to chase down 191 at Old Trafford. This puts England 1-0 up in the five-match series.

ON AIR – What a recovery from England! Are you following the T20 series, and what are your predictions for the rest of it?
CRICKET · UK

5 **A Premier League feud is about to hit the world stage as Erling Haaland's Norway meet Gabriel's Brazil at the World Cup!**

The Manchester City striker and Arsenal defender have had some feisty encounters in the past. It's set to be an intriguing battle when their nations go head-to-head.

ON AIR – Which Premier League player rivalry are you most excited to see play out on the world stage this World Cup?
FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A study suggests humming or singing badly in the car genuinely lifts your mood.**
Researchers link it to deep breathing and a small dose of joy. Fellow drivers at the lights may not share the enthusiasm.
- 2 Brits spend an average of 38 minutes a day deciding what to watch — and 12 of those are spent scrolling Netflix.**
'Watch-paralysis' has its own subreddit. Streamers are quietly experimenting with 'shuffle' buttons that just play something.
- 3 More people are writing 'done lists' instead of to-do lists to feel better about their day.**
Noting what you actually achieved, however small, apparently beats staring at everything you didn't. 'Got dressed' counts.
- 4 British baby names are getting shorter again — three- and four-letter names are dominating the registrar.**
Top picks this year: Noa, Ezra, Ada and Bo. Long, multi-syllable Victorian names like Theodora are sliding back down the chart.
- 5 Loneliness is now considered a bigger health risk than smoking 15 cigarettes a day, according to NHS England.**
Social prescribing — GPs referring patients to community activities — is rolling out nationwide. Walking groups, book clubs and choirs are reportedly oversubscribed.
- 6 More of us are learning the names of the birds in our gardens, apps report.**
Bird-ID apps have made spotting easier. The robin remains the nation's clear favourite, mostly for its cheek.
- 7 A survey says most of us have a 'signature dish' we bring out whenever guests come round.**
Chilli, lasagne and a roast top the list. Very few of us, it turns out, have a second dish ready if the first goes wrong.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q 64% of us keep THIS even though we've never once read it.
ANSWER: THE INSTRUCTION MANUAL FOR THE MICROWAVE.

Q The thing we most often say we 'don't really watch' but absolutely do is THIS.
ANSWER: REALITY TV.

TALK TOPIC

- **A new study says most people have a 'comfort programme' they put on to fall asleep.**
What do you drift off to — and does your other half agree with the choice?

- **Apparently most of us have one thing we collect without ever meaning to.**
What have you somehow ended up with dozens of — tote bags, mugs, odd socks?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **The Human Body.** You're about one centimetre taller in the morning than at night, because the soft discs in your spine compress slightly over the course of the day.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Opticians have reported a rise in people asking for glasses with a built-in tiny wiper blade, for 'reading outdoors in the British summer'.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£5 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£5 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The plastic bits on the ends of shoelaces are called aglets.
- Penguins propose to their mates by giving them a pebble.
- Strawberries aren't actually berries, but bananas, watermelons and pumpkins are.
- Cats have a special collarbone that lets them always land on their feet — usually.
- The word 'set' has the most definitions of any word in the English language — 430.
- The longest English word without a vowel is 'rhythms'.
- Ketchup was sold in the 1830s as medicine.
- Hippos secrete their own natural sunscreen — a reddish, oily substance.

On this day

Day 187 of the year, 178 days left in 2026. Today The first day of the Festival of San Fermin, which lasts until July 14. (Pamplona); Christian feast day: Goar of Aquitaine; Christian feast day: Maria Goretti; Christian feast day: Blessed Mary Theresa Ledóchowska. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1980 — Joell Ortiz, American rapper
- 1939 — Mary Peters, English-Irish pentathlete and shot putter
- 1979 — Kevin Hart, American comedian, actor, producer, and screenwriter
- 1998 — Comethazine, American rapper
- 1937 — Ned Beatty, American actor (died 2021)
- 1946 — Sylvester Stallone, American actor, director, and screenwriter
- 1978 — Tia Mowry, American actress and producer
- 1949 — Phyllis Hyman, American singer-songwriter and actress (died 1995)

THE DAY TODAY

- 1947 — Referendum held in Sylhet to decide its fate in the Partition of India.
- 1962 — The Late Late Show, the world's longest-running chat show by the same broadcaster, airs on RTÉ One for the first time.
- 2013 — A 73-car oil train derails in the town of Lac-Mégantic, Quebec and explodes into flames, killing at least 47 people and destroying more than 30 buildings in the town's central area.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1966 — Malawi becomes a republic, with Hastings Banda as its first President.
- 2006 — The Nathu La pass between India and China, sealed during the Sino-Indian War, re-opens for trade after 44 years.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1947 — Referendum held in Sylhet to decide its fate in the Partition of India.
- 1996 — A McDonnell Douglas MD-88 operating as Delta Air Lines Flight 1288 experiences a turbine engine failure during takeoff from Pensacola International Airport, killing two and injuring five of the 147 people on board.

- 1942 — Anne Frank and her family go into hiding in the "Secret Annexe" above her father's office in an Amsterdam warehouse.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 188 of the year, 177 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Æthelburh of Faremoutiers; Christian feast day: Felix of Nantes; Christian feast day: Illidius; Christian feast day: Job of Manyava (Ukrainian Orthodox Church). Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1965 — Jeremy Kyle, English talk show host
- 1988 — Kaci Brown, American singer-songwriter
- 1969 — Cree Summer, American-Canadian actress
- 1965 — Mo Collins, American actress, comedian and screenwriter
- 1968 — Jorja Fox, American actress
- 1972 — Kirsten Vangsness, American actress and writer
- 1970 — Min Patel, Indian-English cricketer
- 1957 — Jonathan Dayton, American director and producer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1963 — Buddhist crisis: Police commanded by Ngô Đình Nhu, brother and chief political adviser of South Vietnam President Ngo Dinh Diem, attacked a group of American journalists who were covering a protest.
- 1959 — Venus occults the star Regulus. This rare event is used to determine the diameter of Venus and the structure of the Venusian atmosphere.
- 2022 — Boris Johnson announces his resignation as leader of the Conservative Party following days of pressure from the Members of Parliament (MPs) during the July 2022 United Kingdom government crisis.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1952 — The ocean liner SS United States passes Bishop Rock on her maiden voyage, breaking the transatlantic speed record to become the fastest passenger ship in the world.
- 1963 — Buddhist crisis: Police commanded by Ngô Đình Nhu, brother and chief political adviser of South Vietnam President Ngo Dinh Diem, attacked a group of American journalists who were covering a protest.

Coming to cinemas

JULY 2026

FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026

FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JULY 2026	
4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
AUGUST 2026	
W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)